

FINDING A BALANCE

INTERNAL COACHING

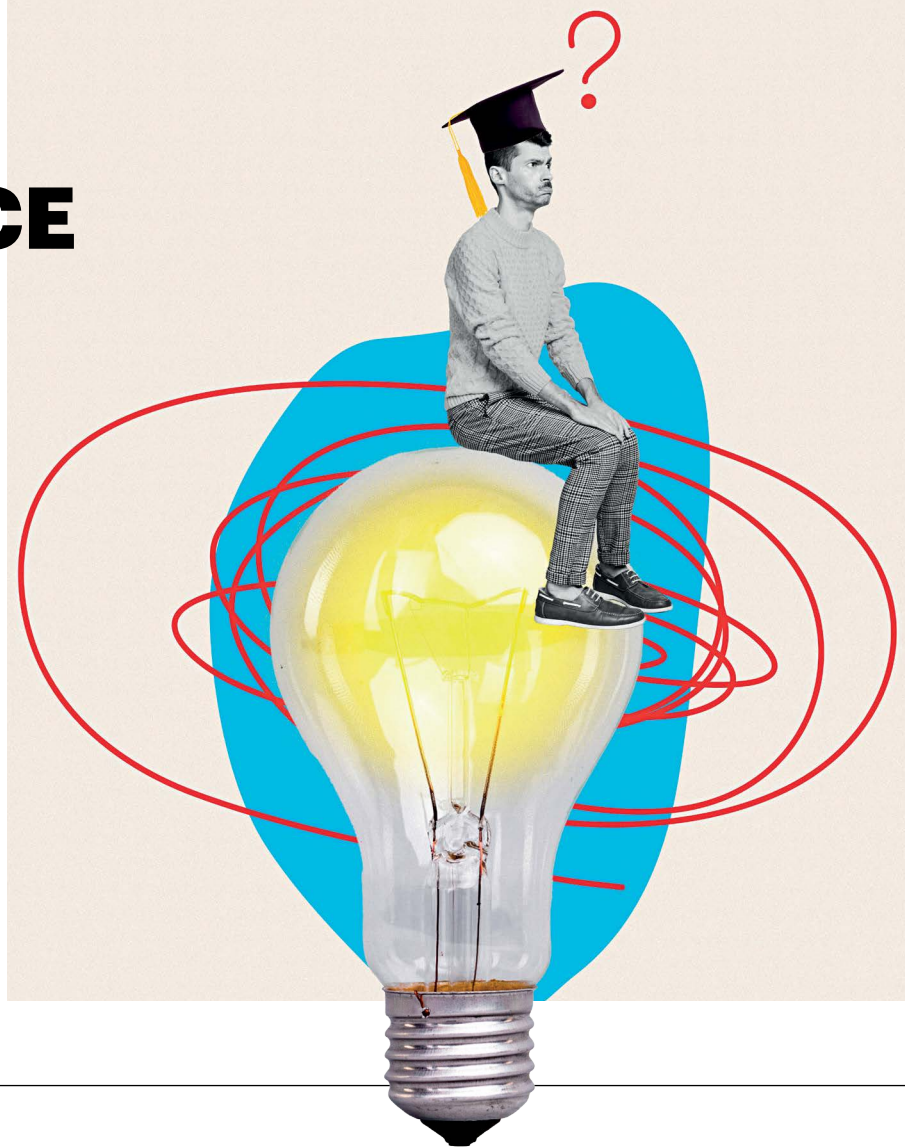
Contextual, Consistent, and Culture-Driven

- Ideal for operational excellence and continuous capability building
- Limitations include potential bias, confidentiality issues, and limited objectivity

EXTERNAL COACHING

Independent, Insightful, and Transformative

- Brings cross-industry experience, specialised expertise, and global frameworks
- Limitations include higher costs and time needed to understand organisational context



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KNOWLEDGE TO ACTION

Across institutions, executive education is being redesigned for a real-world impact.

“At ISB, our executive programmes now follow modular, blended formats combining immersive residencies, applied projects, and peer learning enabling leaders to translate insights into action without leaving their roles,” explains Sood.

This shift is mirrored in organisations with internal leadership universities. “At Mahindra Leadership University (MLU), we are focused on building digitally savvy, future-ready leaders who understand AI and its impact on the future of work and decision-making,” says an M&M spokesperson.

MLU uses an AI-enabled platform that curates personalised learning journeys linked to Mahindra’s business priorities. Partnerships with global institutions such as Oxford, Carnegie Mellon, and IIMs bring academic rigour, while insights from Mahindra leaders ensure contextual relevance and measurable business outcomes.

As more firms establish in-house academies, Professor Mukta Kulkarni, Dean of Academic Programmes, IIM Bangalore, believes B-schools remain indispensable. “Top-tier institutions bring what in-house systems often cannot—multidimensional thinking, access to globally respected faculty, and diverse peer networks,” she says. “What differentiates us,” she adds,

“is our dual role as knowledge creators and ecosystem convenors.”

For Jha, flexibility and immersion define this new architecture: “Senior leaders value learning formats that are immersive yet flexible, experiences that respect their time and intellect and allow application in real business contexts.”

LEARNING, COACHING, CONNECTION

The reinvention of executive education isn’t just structural, it’s human. Coaching has emerged as one of its most transformative elements.

“Internal coaching leverages organisational knowledge and culture. However, they may lack objectivity and face confidentiality